

UNIT 1 · TOPIC 1.7

E-ticketing and IATA E-Ticketing Standards

How a 13-digit number replaced the paper ticket forever.

B.B.A. Aviation Management · Semester III · Unit 1: Overview of the Airline Industry
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**BOARDING PASS**

LEARNER

STU

PROFESSIONAL

**PRO**

FLIGHT

ATF 1.7

GATE

PERIOD 7

DURATION

00:40

SEAT

SEM III

CLASS

LECTURE

BOARDING

NOW

TOPIC 1.7

In-Flight Movie: Topic Intro



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02

TOPIC 1.7

Pre-Flight Question



THINK ABOUT IT

What happened to the paper airline ticket — and what replaced it?

**THINK**

30 seconds alone

**PAIR**

1 minute with a neighbour

**SHARE**

2-3 answers with the class



TOPIC 1.7

Today's Flight Plan

1**1.7.1**

What is e-ticketing: how electronic ticketing revolutionised the airline industry

2**1.7.2**

IATA e-ticketing standards: key regulations and processes

3**1.7.3**

How e-ticketing works: issuance, changes, cancellations and refunds

4**1.7.4**

Advantages: environmental benefits, easier check-in and cost savings

**BY LANDING, YOU WILL**

- Define an e-ticket and read its number
- Explain IATA's role and coupon statuses
- Describe issue, exchange, void and refund
- Evaluate the benefits of e-ticketing

Pedagogy: Lecture-Based Teaching-Learning



TOPIC 1.7.1

From Paper to Electronic



Paper Ticket Era

- Multi-part carbon coupons, one per flight
- Lost ticket = lost travel right, fees to replace
- Printing, courier and storage costs
- Manual audit and settlement



E-Ticket Era

- Record stored in the airline database
- Nothing to lose — just an ID or PNR
- Issued, emailed and changed instantly
- Automatic reporting to IATA BSP



TOPIC 1.7.1

The E-Ticket Revolution

One of the biggest cost savings in airline history.

2008

IATA moves to 100% e-ticketing (1 June 2008)

~US\$9

estimated saving per ticket compared with paper (IATA)

~US\$3 bn

estimated annual industry saving (IATA)



Paper tickets cost about US\$10 each to process vs about US\$1 for an e-ticket — IATA's widely quoted estimate.

TOPIC 1.7.2

Anatomy of an E-Ticket Number

Every IATA ticket number has 13 digits.

- First 3 digits = airline accounting code (e.g., 098 Air India, 176 Emirates).
- Next 10 digits = serial number.
- Each flight in the ticket is a “coupon” with its own status.
- The ticket links back to the PNR record locator.

E-TICKET RECORD (illustrative)

TKT: 098-2412345678
PNR: K7QX2M NAME: SHARMA/RAHUL MR

CPN	FLIGHT	CLS	DATE	STATUS
1	AI 887	Y	20NOV	OPEN
2	AI 888	Y	25NOV	OPEN

// ticket number is invented

TOPIC 1.7.2

Coupon Status Codes (IATA)

The coupon status tells you exactly where each flight stands.

Code	Status	Meaning
O	Open for use	Valid, not yet flown
A	Airport control	Taken over by the airline's departure control near departure
C	Checked in	Passenger has checked in
L / F	Lifted / Flown	Boarded — coupon used
E / R / V	Exchanged / Refunded / Void	Reissued, refunded or cancelled same day

TOPIC 1.7.3

The E-Ticket Lifecycle



TOPIC 1.7.3

Changes, Cancellations & Refunds

Know the right action for each situation.

**Void**

Cancels a ticket on the same day of issue (before BSP reporting). No refund process needed.

**Exchange / Reissue**

New ticket replaces old for date or route change; old ticket status becomes E.

**Refund**

Unused coupons refunded as per fare rule, minus penalties; taxes usually refundable.

**Involuntary**

Airline-caused cancellations: rebook or full refund, often penalty-free.



TOPIC 1.7.4

Advantages of E-Ticketing



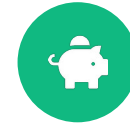
Environmental

No paper coupons, printing or courier — a big reduction in waste.



Easier Check-in

Web and mobile check-in, kiosks and digital boarding passes.



Cost Savings

Lower distribution, storage and audit costs for airlines.



Security

Cannot be lost or stolen; fraud easier to detect.

TOPIC 1.7.4

Beyond E-Tickets: What Comes Next

**EMD**

Electronic Miscellaneous Documents cover extras: bags, seats, lounge, penalties.

**ONE Order**

IATA's plan to replace PNR + ticket + EMD with a single customer order record.

**Digital identity**

Boarding passes on phones and biometric ID (DigiYatra in India).

**BIG PICTURE**

Paper tickets → e-tickets (2008) → offers & orders (NDC / ONE Order). Ticketing professionals must keep learning as the standards evolve.



TOPIC 1.7

Cabin Crew Activity: Decode the E-Ticket

**PEDAGOGY****Lecture-Based Teaching-Learning****TIME · 8 min****FORMAT · Individual worksheet**

- 1 Students receive a sample e-ticket receipt (names/numbers invented).
- 2 Identify: airline code, ticket number, PNR, fare basis and baggage.
- 3 State each coupon status and what it means.
- 4 Decide: void, exchange or refund for three given scenarios.

TOPIC 1.7*Click to reveal each answer*

Pre-Landing Check

Q1**How many digits are in an IATA ticket number?**

- A) 10
- B) 12
- C) 13
- D) 15

ANSWER**C****Q2****The first 3 digits of a ticket number identify the...**

- A) Agent
- B) Airline
- C) Airport
- D) Country

ANSWER**B****Q3****Coupon status “F” means...**

- A) Flown
- B) Frozen
- C) Free
- D) Fare changed

ANSWER**A****Q4****Cancelling a ticket on the same day of issue is called...**

- A) Refund
- B) Reissue
- C) Void
- D) Exchange

ANSWER**C**

SAFE LANDING

Key Takeaways

- ✓ E-tickets replaced paper in 2008 under IATA
- ✓ Ticket = 3-digit airline code + 10-digit serial
- ✓ Coupon statuses show each flight's stage
- ✓ Void, exchange and refund each have clear rules

EXIT TICKET Write 1 thing you learned today + 1 question you still have.

NEXT DEPARTURE

Topic 1.8 — Travel Agencies and OTAs

Thank you · Questions?